

two drives will ship in the fourth quarter of 2004. This puts a timeframe on the 60 GB iPod that has been anticipated ever since a Toshiba staffer admitted that the company had a 60 GB model in the works, and that Apple was a big-time customer.

Pricing, however, is yet to be disclosed.

OPT-IN REQUIRED

FCC Bans Cell Phone Spam

The US Federal Communications Commission has finally decided to crack the whip. The FCC recently voted to outlaw all unauthorised

text messages to mobiles and pagers without permission from the owner. However, it remains to be seen whether the law is going to actually work.

The US Congress sought strict rules for cell phone spam from the FCC last year, while passing the Controlling the Assault of Non-Solicited Pornography and Marketing (CAN-SPAM) Act of 2003 last year. CAN-SPAM allows spammers to send unsolicited commercial e-mail to e-mail accounts until the recipient opts out of receiving e-mail from that sender. But it hasn't been too successful in tackling this nuisance.

Opt-out or opt-in, there is little doubt that spammers will dodge the new law

The FCC's action this time requires an opt-in.

Commercial entities sending text messages to mobile phones and pagers must get customers' permission before sending them.

Opt-out or opt-in, there is little doubt that spammers will dodge the new law, and come up with newer ways to spam us. If our fears are right, cell phone and smartphone attacks will shoot up in the years to come.

GOING UPMARKET

Indian PC Market Shoots Up

According to Gartner, the Indian PC market grew 34.6 per cent, with more than 7.6 lakh units being shipped in the second quarter of 2004.

Vinod Nair, Analyst-Computing systems, Gartner India, said, "Healthy economic conditions coupled with increase in run-rate business resulted in a good second quarter this year. The election quarter and expectation of further reduction in prices due to the financial budget caused a marginal halt in desktop purchases during the last two weeks in June... but the upward trend continued."

Desktop sales grew 32 per cent; notebooks grew 123 per cent, constituting five per cent of the total shipments this quarter.

HP was the market leader with a 14.9 per cent share. HCL follows at 11.9 per cent. The growth has come at the expense of assembled PCs.

This indicates four trends. First, the increased market share of branded players means there is little

Trust Busters

In order to write the 'Old Way, Tech Way' article (Page 77), we had to file income tax returns online (Tech Way). Everyone suggested FileMyReturns.com, so we logged on.



They had three plans on offer: The Rs 99 plan, where you do all your calculations online, download the filled forms, and submit them yourself. The second plan costs Rs 200, and the only difference is that they send a representative to pick up the forms from your house and submit them. The third plan costs Rs 250, and only needs you to contact them—their representative comes to you and fills and submits everything.

We applied for all three plans, filled out the contact information, and then waited... and waited... Three days later we e-mailed their helpdesk, nothing... As of going to print, over 10 days after contacting them, and over 15 days after registering on the site, there's still no reply.

to choose between branded and assembled machines. Also, branded players now offer customisation in their PC solutions, and this is something the Indian market sorely needs.



Third, and perhaps most important, companies such as HP and HCL are moving on to services and value-addition.

Finally, with most users having desktop PCs for quite a few years, they are steadily moving towards laptops or high-end machines.

GENDER



BENDERS

Aditya Govindarajan vs. Jayshree Haran Find The Sketcher Tool On The Zire 71 PDA



20 sec.

Aditya, an engineering student, is brimming with confidence, itching to lay his hands on the PDA. No sooner did he grab the gadget that it briskly turns on. He smartly runs the stylus on the screen. In no time, he is looking up the drop-down menu of utilities. Eureka!—"There's the Sketcher," he gasps, beaming. Little time is lost in scurrying back to the main menu again and switching the PDA off. Boy, that was really fast!



1 min 40 sec.

There's a slight worried look on Jayshree's face when she takes hold of the PDA. The engineering student takes a few moments before launching the hunt. Oops, a few unsure moves. More follow. After groping for the utilities for a while more, she finally tracks it down. Ah! So, here's the elusive sketcher. But that's just the job half done. She's gotta escape. She rummages all over the screen with the stylus, looking for the main menu, overlooking it several times, till she finally manages to make it.